

Dragonfly Music Center

318 West Read Street, Baltimore, MD 21201 | Tel: (410) 555-0270 | dragonflymusiccenter.com

Fingerstyle Technique Intensive - Workshop Syllabus

Instructor: Gerald Marie Roman, PhD | November 14, 2026 | 10:00 AM to 1:00 PM

Format:	3-hour hands-on workshop, maximum 8 participants
Skill Level:	Intermediate (participants should have basic chord knowledge and single-note playing ability)
Fee:	\$100 per participant (paid through Dragonfly registration; includes printed tablature packet)
Materials to Bring:	Your own acoustic guitar (steel-string recommended; nylon-string also fine). A capo if you own one. Finger picks optional.
Room:	Studio B, second floor

Workshop Description

Fingerstyle guitar is the art of playing melody, harmony, and bass simultaneously on a single instrument. This workshop introduces the core techniques that allow a guitarist to move from strumming chords to making the guitar sound like more than one instrument at once. We will cover the fundamentals of the Travis pick, basic alternating bass patterns, and how to integrate a melodic line against a moving bass. By the end of the session, participants will be able to play through a short arrangement of a folk melody in fingerstyle format and will have tools to continue developing the technique independently.

The instructor, Gerald Roman, has been playing fingerstyle acoustic guitar for 25 years, learned the tradition directly from her grandmother, and continues to perform and teach across the Baltimore and DC area. Her approach is rooted in the folk and Americana fingerstyle tradition.

Schedule

10:00 to 10:20

Introduction and warm-up. Right-hand placement, thumb and finger independence exercises. Every participant plays a few bars so the instructor can assess starting points.

10:20 to 11:00

Session 1: The Travis Pick. Introduction to alternating bass pattern with Merle Travis style picking. Exercise 1 (tablature p.1): basic pattern in G major, open position. Common errors and how to fix them.

Individual attention rounds.

11:00 to 11:15

Short break - tune up, stretch hands, questions.

11:15 to 12:00

Session 2: Adding the Melody. How to bring a melodic line into the treble strings without losing the bass. Exercise 2 (tablature p.2 to 3): arrangement of 'Shady Grove' in D modal tuning (DADGAD). Participants work through first two phrases.

12:00 to 12:30

Session 3: Putting it together. Full run-through of the short arrangement. Participants play together at reduced tempo. Individual feedback.

12:30 to 1:00

Open Q&A and practice time. Resources list distributed. What to practice next week. Recommended listening list.

Tablature Packet Contents (distributed at workshop)

- p.1 - Exercise 1: Travis pick pattern in G, C, and D
- p.2 - Exercise 2a: 'Shady Grove' melody line (right hand only)
- p.3 - Exercise 2b: Full arrangement 'Shady Grove' in DADGAD (intro through verse 2)
- p.4 - Exercise 3: Alternating bass with hammer-on embellishments in Am
- p.5 - Suggested practice routine (15 minutes per day)
- p.6 - Recommended listening: Tommy Emmanuel, Andy McKee, Kaki King, Davey Graham, Mississippi John Hurt
- p.7 - Online resources and tuning reference

Contact and Follow-up

Participants who would like a follow-up private lesson or have questions after the workshop can contact the instructor directly at gerald.roman@gmail.com. Workshop alumni are also welcome to attend future Dragonfly sessions at the returning-student rate.

Workshop registration and cancellation policy: full refund if cancelled 7 or more days before the event; no refund within 7 days but the registration may be transferred to a future session.